Acme Corp IT and HR Policy Handbook

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This handbook applies to all full-time employees, contractors, and interns of Acme Corp across all regional offices. Where local law is stricter than this policy, local law prevails.

1. Remote Work Policy

1.1 Eligibility and Philosophy

Acme Corp believes that great work can happen anywhere, provided that the conditions for focus, collaboration, and security are met, and this belief has shaped our hybrid model since 2021 when the company first moved away from a mandatory five-day office presence; employees whose roles do not require physical access to labs, warehouses, or customer sites are eligible to work remotely for up to three days per week after completing their 90-day probation period, although managers retain the discretion to request in-office attendance for onboarding sessions, quarterly planning events, client workshops, and any situation where in-person collaboration is judged to be materially better for the outcome, and employees who wish to work remotely for more than three days per week, or from a country other than their country of employment for longer than 14 consecutive calendar days, must submit a Remote Work Exception Request through the HR portal at least 30 days in advance so that Legal, Payroll, and Information Security can assess tax residency, data-protection, and export-control implications before approval is granted.

1.2 Remote Work Rules

All remote employees must follow these rules at all times:

• Work only from a private, secure location; public spaces such as cafés and airports are permitted for a maximum of 2 hours per day.

• Always connect through the corporate VPN (**Acme GlobalConnect**) before accessing internal systems.

• Never leave a company laptop unattended and unlocked, even at home.

• Be reachable on Slack and email during your team's core hours (10:00–15:00 local time).

• Report any lost or stolen device to the IT Service Desk within **1 hour** of noticing.

• After hours, call the 24/7 security hotline at extension 4357.

• Do not print confidential documents on personal or shared printers.

2. IT Equipment and Security

2.1 Hardware Allowance

Each employee receives a one-time hardware allowance at joining and a refresh allowance every three years. Amounts depend on role category:

Role Category	Laptop Budget (USD)	Monitor Allowance (USD)	Accessories (USD)	Refresh Cycle
Engineering & Data	2,500	600	250	3 years
Design & Creative	2,800	900	300	3 years

Role Category	Laptop Budget (USD)	Monitor Allowance (USD)	Accessories (USD)	Refresh Cycle
Sales & Marketing	1,600	300	150	3 years
Operations & Support	1,400	300	100	4 years

Unused allowance does not roll over and cannot be converted to cash. Purchases above the allowance require written approval from a department head.

2.2 Password and Access Requirements

Passwords for corporate accounts must be at least 14 characters long and must not be reused across systems. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for email, VPN, the HR portal, and all production systems.

To check your laptop's encryption status, IT recommends running the following command:

```
# Check FileVault status on macOS
fdesetup status
# Expected output: FileVault is On.
```

Note: *If the output says FileVault is Off, open a P2 ticket with the IT Service Desk immediately. Do not store any customer data on the device until encryption is confirmed.*

3. Leave and Time Off

3.1 Annual Leave

Full-time employees accrue 1.75 days of paid annual leave per month, totaling 21 days per calendar year. Up to 5 unused days may be carried forward into the first quarter of the following year; any remaining days expire on March 31.

3.2 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 3 consecutive working days.

3.3 Requesting Leave

1. Submit the request in the HR portal at least 10 working days in advance for planned leave.
2. Your manager approves or declines within 3 working days.
3. Update your Slack status and calendar once approved.

4. Information Security and Acceptable Use

4.1 Data Classification

All information created, received, or stored by Acme Corp must be assigned one of four classification levels by its owner. When in doubt, classify one level higher and ask the Information Security team to review.

Level	Label	Examples	Storage Allowed	External Sharing
L1	Public	Press releases, published blog posts, job ads	Any approved system	Allowed

Level	Label	Examples	Storage Allowed	External Sharing
L2	Internal	Org charts, this handbook, internal wiki pages	Corporate Google Drive, Notion	Only under NDA
L3	Confidential	Customer contracts, salary data, roadmaps	Restricted Drive folders only	Requires Legal approval
L4	Restricted	Customer PII, payment data, security keys	Approved vault or encrypted DB	Never

Documents labelled L3 or L4 must display the classification in the file name or document header (for example, `ROADMAP-2027_L3.pdf`).

4.2 Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company laptops, accounts, networks, and software licenses are provided primarily for business purposes, and while Acme Corp permits limited, reasonable personal use such as checking personal email during a lunch break, reading the news, or making a short personal video call, this privilege must never interfere with work responsibilities, consume significant bandwidth or storage, expose the company to legal or reputational risk, or involve activities such as cryptocurrency mining, torrenting copyrighted material, operating a personal business, accessing gambling or adult content, or installing browser extensions and desktop applications that have not been approved by IT; employees should also understand that all activity on company-managed devices and networks may be logged and monitored in accordance with applicable law for the purposes of security, compliance, and incident investigation, that monitoring is performed by the Information Security team under documented procedures with access restricted to authorized personnel, and that employees should therefore have no expectation of privacy for personal data they choose to store on company systems, which is why we strongly recommend keeping personal files, photos, and passwords on personal devices and accounts instead.

4.3 Prohibited Activities

The following are strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination:

• Sharing your credentials with anyone, including colleagues and IT staff.

• IT will **never** ask for your password by email, chat, or phone.

• Disabling or bypassing endpoint protection, disk encryption, or the VPN.

• Forwarding L3 or L4 data to personal email accounts or messaging apps.

• Uploading customer data or source code into unapproved AI tools or public code-sharing sites.

• Approved AI tools are listed on the IT wiki page *Approved AI Tools Register*.

• If a tool is not on the register, submit a request using the form described in Section 5.2.

• Connecting unknown USB storage devices to company equipment.

• Using company resources to harass, threaten, or discriminate against anyone.

4.4 Reporting a Security Incident

If you suspect a phishing email, malware infection, data leak, or unauthorized access, report it immediately. Speed matters more than certainty; we would rather investigate ten false alarms than miss one real incident.

4.4.1 Severity Matrix

Severity	Description	Example	Response Target
SEV-1	Active breach or confirmed data exposure	Customer database visible on the internet	15 minutes
SEV-2	Likely compromise of a user or system	Laptop showing ransomware message	1 hour
SEV-3	Suspicious activity, no confirmed impact	Phishing email clicked, no data entered	4 hours
SEV-4	Policy violation with no security impact	Unapproved browser extension installed	2 working days

Remember: *Do not attempt to investigate, delete evidence, or "clean up" a suspected incident yourself.*

 # This line is part of a quote, not a heading.

Disconnect from the network and wait for instructions from the Security team.

5. Software and SaaS Procurement

5.1 Approved Software

The IT team maintains a catalogue of pre-approved software that any employee can install through the self-service portal without additional approval. This includes office productivity suites, approved browsers, password managers, communication tools, and common developer tools such as Git, Docker Desktop, and VS Code.

5.2 Requesting New Software

To request software that is not in the catalogue, follow these steps:

1. Search the catalogue first to confirm no approved alternative exists.

2. Submit a *Software Request* ticket that includes:

1. The business purpose and the expected number of users.

2. The vendor name and a link to its security or trust page.

3. The classification level of the data the tool will process.

3. Information Security completes a vendor risk review within 10 working days.

4. If the tool will process L3 or L4 data, Legal reviews the vendor's data processing agreement.

5. Procurement negotiates the contract and IT provisions licenses through single sign-on (SSO).

Free trials and "freemium" tools are **not** exempt from this process if they will process any company data.

5.3 Software License Costs

Annual license costs are charged to the requesting department's budget. The approval thresholds are:

Annual Cost (USD)	Approver
Under 1,000	Team manager

Annual Cost (USD)	Approver
1,000 – 10,000	Department head
10,001 – 50,000	Department head + Finance
Over 50,000	CFO and CTO (joint approval)

6. Travel and Expenses

6.1 Booking Business Travel

All flights, hotels, and rail travel must be booked through the corporate travel platform so that the company can locate and support employees in an emergency. Economy class is the default for all flights; premium economy is permitted for flights longer than 8 hours, and business class requires prior written approval from a member of the executive team.

6.2 Daily Allowances

Meal and incidental allowances are paid per full travel day. Partial days (departure and return) are paid at 75% of the daily rate.

Region	Meals (USD/day)	Incidentals (USD/day)	Hotel Cap (USD/night)
North America	75	15	250
Western Europe	70	15	220
India	40	10	130
Southeast Asia	45	10	150
Major hubs (NYC, London, SF)	90	20	350

6.3 Submitting Expense Claims

Expense claims must be submitted within **30 days** of the expense being incurred. Every claim requires:

• An itemized receipt (a credit card statement alone is not sufficient).

• The business purpose and, for meals, the names of attendees.

• The correct cost center code.

Claims submitted more than 90 days late will not be reimbursed except in exceptional circumstances approved by Finance. Alcohol is reimbursable only at client entertainment events and is capped at two drinks per person.

7. Code of Conduct

7.1 Respectful Workplace

Acme Corp is committed to a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. This commitment applies in offices, at client sites, at company events, during business travel, and in all digital channels including Slack, email, and video calls. Behaviour that would be inappropriate in a meeting room is equally inappropriate in a direct message.

7.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose any situation in which their personal interests could conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of Acme Corp. Common examples include:

• Holding a financial interest in a supplier, customer, or competitor.

• Hiring or directly managing a close family member or partner.

• Accepting a second job or board position with a company in a related industry.

• Accepting gifts or hospitality worth more than **USD 100** from a current or prospective business partner.

Disclosures are made through the *Conflict of Interest* form in the HR portal and are reviewed confidentially by HR and Legal. Disclosing a conflict is not a violation; failing to disclose one is.

7.3 Speaking Up

Employees who witness or suspect a breach of this handbook, the law, or our values are encouraged to raise it with their manager, HR, or Legal. Reports can also be made anonymously through the independent Ethics Hotline, which is available 24/7 in 12 languages. Acme Corp strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

8. Performance and Development

8.1 Review Cycle

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in March and September. Each review consists of a self-assessment, peer feedback from at least two colleagues, and a manager assessment. Ratings use a five-point scale:

Rating	Label	Meaning
5	Exceptional	Consistently exceeds expectations and raises the bar
4	Strong	Frequently exceeds expectations in key areas
3	Solid	Fully meets the expectations of the role
2	Developing	Meets some expectations; improvement plan agreed
1	Not Meeting	Does not meet expectations; formal support plan required

8.2 Learning Budget

Every full-time employee receives an annual learning budget of USD 1,200, which can be spent on courses, certifications, conference tickets, and books related to their current role or a realistic future role at Acme Corp. Unused budget does not carry over. Employees who receive more than USD 3,000 in sponsored certification costs in a single year agree to a pro-rated repayment if they resign voluntarily within 12 months of completion.

9. Onboarding and Offboarding

9.1 New Joiner Checklist

During their first week, every new employee must complete the following:

1. Sign the employment contract, NDA, and this handbook acknowledgement.

2. Collect and set up company hardware:

• Enable disk encryption (see Section 2.2).

• Enroll the device in mobile device management (MDM).

• Install the corporate VPN client.

3. Complete mandatory training modules:

• Security Awareness (45 minutes).

• Data Protection and Privacy (30 minutes).

• Respectful Workplace (30 minutes).

4. Meet with their assigned onboarding buddy.

9.2 Leaving Acme Corp

Employees who resign must give the notice period stated in their contract. On or before the last working day, the departing employee and their manager must ensure that all company equipment is returned, all access is revoked, and knowledge is handed over.

Important: Access to all systems is disabled automatically at **18:00 local time** on the employee's last working day. Personal files must be removed from company devices before this time.

10. Glossary

MFA – Multi-factor authentication; logging in with a password plus a second factor such as an authenticator app.

MDM – Mobile device management; software that lets IT secure and update company devices remotely.

SSO – Single sign-on; one corporate login used to access many approved applications.

PII – Personally identifiable information, such as names, addresses, phone numbers, or ID numbers.

SEV – Severity level used to prioritize security incidents (see Section 4.4.1).

11. Contacts

For questions about this policy, contact the People & Technology Office at policy@acme-corp.example or the IT Service Desk at extension 4000.